

■ GLOBAL POLICY — Minimum Standards for All KBC Group Entities

POL-T001

KBC Group Global Travel Policy

All KBC Group Entities | Belgium | Czech Republic | Hungary | Slovakia | Bulgaria

Policy ID	POL-T001
Version	v1.2
Effective Date	01 January 2025
Next Review	01 January 2026
Status	Active
Policy Owner	Group CFO / Group Chief People Officer
Applies To	All KBC Group Entities Belgium Czech Republic Hungary Slovakia Bulgaria
Policy Hierarchy	■ GLOBAL POLICY — Minimum Standards for All KBC Group Entities
Classification	INTERNAL — All KBC Group Employees

About this policy: This policy sets the Group-wide minimum standards for business travel across all KBC Group entities. It governs travel pre-approval, air and rail class of travel, accommodation limits, expense reimbursement, duty of care, and non-compliance. Local entity policies must supplement — not reduce — these standards.

Policy hierarchy note

This policy forms part of KBC Group's two-tier travel policy framework. The **Global Travel Policy** (POL-T001) sets the minimum standards and non-negotiable principles applicable across all KBC Group entities. The **Local Travel Policy — KBC Bank NV Belgium** (POL-T002) supplements the global standards with Belgium-specific expense limits, booking procedures, and KATE integration guidance. Where local provisions are more restrictive than global standards, the local standard applies. Where a topic is addressed globally but not locally, the global standard governs.

Contents

- 1** Introduction and Purpose
- 2** Who This Policy Applies To
- 3** Travel Pre-Approval
- 4** Air Travel
- 5** Rail Travel
- 6** Accommodation
- 7** Expense Reimbursement and Currency
- 8** Expense Reporting
- 9** Ground Transportation
- 10** Meals and Entertainment
- 11** Travel Safety and Duty of Care
- 12** Non-Compliance
- 13** Exceptions
- 14** Getting Help
- 15** Policy Review

1. Introduction and Purpose

KBC Group operates across Belgium, Czech Republic, Hungary, Slovakia, and Bulgaria, with employees regularly travelling domestically and internationally to serve clients, attend regulatory engagements, and collaborate across entities. This policy sets the Group-wide framework for business travel — establishing minimum standards, approval requirements, and reimbursement rules that apply consistently across all KBC Group entities.

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that business travel is undertaken only when genuinely necessary, that it represents good value for KBC, and that the safety and wellbeing of travelling employees is protected at all times. KBC Group entities may supplement this policy with local standards, provided those local standards are no less restrictive than the Group minimum requirements set out here.

Global vs Local hierarchy

This is the KBC Group Global Travel Policy. It sets the floor — the minimum standards that every KBC entity must meet. Where a local policy exists for a specific entity, that local policy governs day-to-day travel for employees of that entity. Local policies must not reduce the protections or controls set out in this document.

2. Who This Policy Applies To

This policy applies to all KBC Group employees, contractors, and temporary staff who travel on KBC business, regardless of the entity that employs them or the country in which they are based. It applies to all forms of business travel — domestic and international, by air, rail, road, and sea.

Senior executives at Managing Director level and above are subject to supplementary travel provisions set out in the KBC Group Senior Executive Compensation and Benefits Policy, which takes precedence over this policy for that population.

3. Travel Pre-Approval

3.1 When Pre-Approval is Required

All business travel with an estimated total cost exceeding **EUR 1,000** requires pre-approval from the employee's line manager before any booking is made. This threshold applies to the combined estimated cost of flights, accommodation, ground transport, and subsistence for the entire trip.

Travel to countries classified as High Risk in the KBC Group Security Risk Register requires pre-approval from both the line manager and the Group Security team, regardless of cost. A list of High Risk countries is maintained by Group Security and updated quarterly.

3.2 Approval Process

Pre-approval requests must be submitted through the KBC Travel Portal or, where the Travel Portal is unavailable, by email to the line manager with a copy to the relevant entity's Finance team. The request must include: the destination, purpose of travel, estimated dates, estimated cost breakdown, and whether any alternatives to travel (video conference, delegation) were considered.

Line managers must respond to pre-approval requests within two business days. Silence does not constitute approval. If a line manager is unavailable, the request escalates automatically to the second-line manager after 48 hours.

4. Air Travel

4.1 Booking Requirements

All flights must be booked through KBC's preferred travel management company (TMC) or the KBC Travel Portal. Direct bookings through airlines or third-party platforms are not permitted unless the TMC and Travel Portal are both unavailable and the booking is genuinely urgent, in which case the booking must be retrospectively registered in the Travel Portal within 24 hours.

4.2 Class of Travel

Economy class is the standard for all flights. **Business class is only permitted for flights where the total scheduled flying time (excluding connections) exceeds 6 hours**, or where a medical certificate provided by an occupational health physician confirms a clinical need for additional space or accessibility. Premium economy is permitted for flights between 4 and 6 hours at the employee's own cost differential, unless the employee is at Director level or above.

Business class upgrades using personal loyalty points are permitted and do not require pre-approval, provided the base fare is economy class. The cost differential between business and economy must not be charged to KBC.

4.3 Advance Booking

Flights must be booked at least 14 days in advance wherever operationally possible. Last-minute bookings (within 72 hours of departure) that are not genuinely urgent must be approved by the line manager and flagged to the Finance team. A 'last-minute' surcharge analysis is included in the monthly travel cost report to the Group CFO.

4.4 Stopovers and Connecting Flights

Where a direct flight and a connecting flight are both available, the connecting flight should be selected if the price difference exceeds EUR 200 and the additional travel time does not exceed 3 hours. Where a direct flight is selected for convenience above this threshold, the cost difference must be justified in the expense claim.

5. Rail Travel

Rail travel is the preferred mode of transport for journeys within Europe where the rail journey time is comparable to the equivalent air journey including airport transfers. KBC Group actively encourages rail travel as part of its commitment to reducing the carbon footprint of business travel.

Standard class is the default for all rail journeys. First class is permitted for journeys exceeding 3 hours, for employees at Senior Manager level and above, or where standard class is sold out for a journey that cannot be rescheduled. Eurostar and Thalys bookings follow the same class-of-travel rules.

Why we prefer rail

A Brussels to Paris return by rail produces approximately 3.5 kg CO₂ equivalent. The same journey by air produces approximately 87 kg CO₂ equivalent — 25 times more. KBC's climate transition plan commits to reducing business travel emissions by 30% by 2027. Rail is a material part of delivering that commitment.

6. Accommodation

6.1 Hotel Standards and Rate Limits

Accommodation must be booked through the KBC Travel Portal or preferred hotel programme. The following nightly rate limits (inclusive of all taxes and charges) apply across KBC Group:

Region	Standard Limit (per night)	Exception Limit (per night)
Western Europe (excl. London)	EUR 200	EUR 250 (prior approval)
London	GBP 220	GBP 275 (prior approval)
Central & Eastern Europe	EUR 130	EUR 160 (prior approval)
North America	USD 250	USD 300 (prior approval)
Asia Pacific	USD 220	USD 270 (prior approval)
Rest of World	EUR 150	EUR 200 (prior approval)

Exceptions to the standard limit require approval from the line manager and must be supported by evidence that no compliant accommodation was available (e.g. conference proximity, security requirement, or fully booked preferred properties). The exception limit requires Finance team notification.

6.2 Length of Stay

Employees should not book accommodation for the night before a morning meeting unless the meeting starts before 10:00 local time and travelling the same morning would require departure before 06:00. Additional nights at the employee's own cost are permitted where the employee chooses to extend the stay for personal reasons, provided this does not increase the overall trip cost to KBC.

6.3 Airbnb and Alternative Accommodation

Airbnb, private rentals, and similar unregulated accommodation platforms are not permitted for KBC business travel due to safety, insurance, and duty of care concerns. KBC's travel insurance does not cover stays in non-commercial accommodation.

7. Expense Reimbursement and Currency

7.1 Currency of Reimbursement

All expenses incurred in a foreign currency will be reimbursed in EUR at the European Central Bank (ECB) mid-market exchange rate applicable at the **last business day of the month in which the expense was incurred**. Employees should not seek to manipulate the timing of expense submissions to benefit from more favourable exchange rates.

7.2 Personal Credit Cards and Corporate Cards

KBC issues corporate travel cards to employees who travel more than three times per year. Corporate card holders must use their corporate card for all business travel expenses. Employees without a corporate card may use personal credit or debit cards and will be reimbursed through the standard payroll cycle. Cash advances are available for travel to jurisdictions where card acceptance is limited, subject to prior Finance team approval.

7.3 Reimbursement Timeline

Expense claims will be processed and reimbursed within **10 business days** of submission of a complete and properly documented expense report. Claims submitted without required receipts or approvals will be returned and the 10-day clock restarted upon resubmission. Employees are encouraged to submit expense claims within 5 business days of completing a trip.

8. Expense Reporting

8.1 Expense Report Requirements

All business travel expenses must be reported through the KBC Expense Management System (Concur). Paper expense claims are not accepted except in exceptional circumstances approved by the Finance team. Each expense item must be supported by a receipt (original or digital scan). Credit card statements are not accepted as receipts.

8.2 Pre-Approval Threshold for Expense Reporting

Expense claims for trips with a total cost exceeding **EUR 800** must include a copy of the pre-travel approval obtained under Section 3. Where no pre-approval was obtained because the estimated cost at the time of booking was below the approval threshold, but the actual cost exceeded EUR 800, a retrospective approval from the line manager must be attached.

8.3 Submission Deadline

Expense reports must be submitted within 30 calendar days of the end of the business trip. Claims submitted after 90 days will not be reimbursed except in exceptional circumstances (extended illness, bereavement, or extended field assignment) approved by the Group CFO's office.

9. Ground Transportation

Taxis and ride-hailing services (Uber, Bolt, etc.) are permitted for airport transfers and where public transport is not reasonably available. KBC employees must use standard service levels — premium or luxury vehicle classes are not reimbursable unless booked through a client-facing account for which the client has been briefed.

Car hire is permitted where rail or taxi is not practical, for example for multi-site visits or locations not served by public transport. The standard car category is economy or compact. SUV, premium, or luxury categories are not reimbursable. GPS and standard insurance must be included in the hire.

Personal vehicles may be used for business travel at the KBC mileage reimbursement rate, which is reviewed annually. The applicable rate for 2025 is EUR 0.40 per kilometre for Belgium. Other entity rates are published on the KBC intranet for the respective jurisdiction.

10. Meals and Entertainment

Subsistence allowances (meals and incidentals) apply when an employee is travelling away from their primary work location for business purposes. The following daily limits apply:

Country / Region	Total Daily Limit	of which: Lunch	of which: Dinner
Belgium	EUR 45	EUR 20	EUR 25
Czech Republic	CZK 1,200 (~EUR 48)	CZK 520	CZK 680
Hungary	HUF 16,000 (~EUR 42)	HUF 7,000	HUF 9,000
UK / London	GBP 55	GBP 22	GBP 33
US / New York	USD 70	USD 30	USD 40
Other Western Europe	EUR 50	EUR 22	EUR 28
CEE (other)	EUR 35	EUR 15	EUR 20

Business entertainment expenses (client dinners, team events) above EUR 100 per person require pre-approval from a Senior Manager. All entertainment expenses must include a list of attendees and business purpose. Entertainment expenses are subject to KBC's Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy and the applicable local hospitality register.

11. Travel Safety and Duty of Care

KBC Group has a duty of care obligation to all employees travelling on business. This means we must know where our employees are when they travel, that they have access to assistance 24/7 if something goes wrong, and that we maintain appropriate travel insurance at all times.

All employees travelling internationally on KBC business must register their trip in the KBC Travel Portal before departure. The portal automatically enrolls the employee in KBC's International SOS programme for the duration of the trip, providing access to 24/7 emergency medical and security assistance.

Employees must not travel to countries on the Belgian Ministry of Foreign Affairs 'Do Not Travel' list (Code Red) or KBC Group Security's 'Restricted' list on KBC business, unless an explicit exception has been approved by Group Security and the relevant entity CEO.

Emergency contact

During business travel, employees can reach the KBC Group Security duty line 24/7 at the number published on the KBC intranet under 'Travel Safety'. International SOS can be reached at the number on the back of your travel card. In a life-threatening emergency, always contact local emergency services first.

12. Non-Compliance

Failure to comply with this policy may result in expenses not being reimbursed, and in repeated or deliberate cases, disciplinary action. Expense claims that include non-compliant items will be returned for correction. Where an employee knowingly submits a false or inflated expense claim, this will be treated as a conduct matter under KBC's Code of Conduct.

13. Exceptions

Exceptions to any provision of this policy require written approval from the employee's line manager and the relevant entity Finance Director. Exceptions for members of the Executive Committee require approval from the Group CFO. Exceptions must be logged in the KBC Expense Management System and are reviewed quarterly by Internal Audit.

14. Getting Help

- **KBC Travel Portal** — for bookings and expense submission.
- **KBC Travel Management Company (TMC)** — for complex itinerary support.
- **HR / Finance team** — for policy questions.
- **KBC Ethics & Compliance Helpline** — for confidential concerns about travel expense fraud.

15. Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually. Local policies must be reviewed whenever the Global Travel Policy is updated. The next scheduled review is January 2026.